

■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, August 18, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ **Orcas wow beachgoers with extremely close encounter | The Moment**

The Angle: Orcas wow beachgoers with extremely close encounter | The Moment

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7310517?cmp=rss>

■ **Zion becomes first national park to get all-terrain wheelchair for public use**

The Angle: Zion becomes first national park to get all-terrain wheelchair for public use

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.ksl.com/article/51610594/zion-becomes-first-national-park-to-get-all-terrain-wheelchair-for-public-use>

■ **It Is Past Time for You to Quit Elon Musk's X**

The Angle: It Is Past Time for You to Quit Elon Musk's X

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://publiccomment.blog/p/it-is-past-time-for-you-to-quit-elon-musk-s-x>

■ **The economy has spoken. Stuff that's AI-generated has almost zero value — “Buyers are voting with their wallets, and AI-generated content is struggling to compete.”**

The Angle: The economy has spoken. Stuff that's AI-generated has almost zero value — “Buyers are voting with their wallets, and AI-generated content is struggling to compete.”

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://finance.yahoo.com/technology/ai/articles/economy-spoken-stuff-ai-generated-142732314.html>

■ **CEO who fired 900 employees over Zoom gets fired, demands job back**

The Angle: CEO who fired 900 employees over Zoom gets fired, demands job back

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://local12.com/news/nation-world/ceo-fired-zoom-vishal-garg-better-home-finance-demands-job-back-call-holiday-season-2021-roles-reversed-tables-turned-chief-executive-officer-ousted-board-company-stock-price-market-value>

Backup options:

■ **Microsoft confirms GitHub is down worldwide**

The Angle: Microsoft confirms GitHub is down worldwide

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/microsoft/microsoft-confirms-github-is-down-worldwide/>

■ **Russian, U.S. interests are targeting Alberta's separatist debate, Canadian research shows**

The Angle: Russian, U.S. interests are targeting Alberta's separatist debate, Canadian research shows

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.theglobeandmail.com/canada/article-new-data-from-canadian-researchers-shows-how-russian-us-interests-are/>

■ **Canadian icon Jann Arden marries Icelandic author Thordis Elva: 'Wife and wife'**

The Angle: Canadian icon Jann Arden marries Icelandic author Thordis Elva: 'Wife and wife'

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/jann-arden-thordis-elva-married-9.7309495>

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ **Teen rehab facility Provo Canyon shuts down amidst YouTuber Reckless Ben infiltrating it and capturing illegal practices on film.**

The Angle: Teen rehab facility Provo Canyon shuts down amidst YouTuber Reckless Ben infiltrating it and capturing illegal practices on film.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/r/Fauxmoi/comments/1vrf2st/teen_rehab_facility_provo_canyon_shuts_down/

■ **NYC Mayor Zohran Mamdani speaking Mandarin to promote free Broadway tickets for the city's high school students.**

The Angle: NYC Mayor Zohran Mamdani speaking Mandarin to promote free Broadway tickets for the city's high school students.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://v.redd.it/5qmt6l3wbzjh1>

■ **Hayden Panettiere's 'Nashville' mom says late actress's 'inner demons' were 'too much to bear'**

The Angle: Hayden Panettiere's 'Nashville' mom says late actress's 'inner demons' were 'too much to bear'

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/18/celebrity-news/hayden-panettieres-nashville-mom-says-late-actresss-inner-demons-were-too-much-to-bear/>

■ **Hayden Panettiere's 'second mother' says actress 'never stood a chance' after being raised in Hollywood**

The Angle: Hayden Panettiere's 'second mother' says actress 'never stood a chance' after being raised in Hollywood

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/08/18/us-news/hayden-panettieres-second-mother-says-actress-never-stood-a-chance-after-being-raised-in-hollywood/>

Backup options:

■ **Harrison Ford, 84, shocks fans with new Indiana Jones announcement - pagesix.com**

The Angle: Harrison Ford, 84, shocks fans with new Indiana Jones announcement - pagesix.com

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/16/celebrity-news/harrison-ford-84-shocks-fans-with-new-indiana-jones-announcement/>

■ **'Star Wars: Starfighter' Was Inspired by a Francis Ford Coppola Classic**

The Angle: 'Star Wars: Starfighter' Was Inspired by a Francis Ford Coppola Classic

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://gizmodo.com/star-wars-starfighter-was-inspired-by-a-francis-ford-coppola-classic-2000799631>

■ **Edinburgh Film Festival Competition Directors on the Craziest, Most Challenging Moments Making Their First Features and Why They Can't Wait to Do It Again: 'It's an Addiction'**

The Angle: Edinburgh Film Festival Competition Directors on the Craziest, Most Challenging Moments Making Their First Features and Why They Can't Wait to Do It Again: 'It's an Addiction'

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://variety.com/2026/film/global/edinburgh-film-festival-competition-director-variety-lounge-1236836981/>

■ **Snips Partners With Banijay Rights and BIG Media to Turn Library Titles Like 'Big Brother' and 'Humans' Into Short-Form, Vertical Episodes (EXCLUSIVE)**

The Angle: Snips Partners With Banijay Rights and BIG Media to Turn Library Titles Like 'Big Brother' and 'Humans' Into Short-Form, Vertical Episodes (EXCLUSIVE)

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/snips-banijay-rights-big-media-vertical-episodes-1236836812/>

TRENDING TODAY

■ **What does 'polyester' have to do with Gen Z? Everything, apparently - USA Today**

The Angle: What does 'polyester' have to do with Gen Z? Everything, apparently - USA Today

USA Today (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.usatoday.com/story/life/health-wellness/2026/08/17/polyester-gen-z-tiktok-insult-explained/91285172007/>

Backup options:

■ **Meta faces a \$1.4 trillion reckoning in latest trial over social media addiction**

The Angle: Meta faces a \$1.4 trillion reckoning in latest trial over social media addiction

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.engadget.com/2237547/meta-faces-a-1-4-trillion-reckoning-in-latest-trial-over-social-media-addiction/>

■ **Less than 20% of Canadians want to give U.S. 'concessions,' poll finds**

The Angle: Less than 20% of Canadians want to give U.S. 'concessions,' poll finds

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://globalnews.ca/news/12023832/canadians-trump-tariffs/>

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ ***Of more than 500 occupations in the United States, flight attendants and pilots have the highest and second-highest proportion of radiation-related cancer deaths, a new study has found.***

The Angle: *Of more than 500 occupations in the United States, flight attendants and pilots have the highest and second-highest proportion of radiation-related cancer deaths, a new study has found.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://hms.harvard.edu/news/pilots-flight-attendants-have-greater-risk-radiation-related-cancer-death-other-professions>

Backup options:

■ ***Historically, there was very strong guidance that you must always finish an antibiotic course. Now, we're seeing a growing body of evidence saying that that is not always the case. And oftentimes, shorter durations of antibiotics are as effective and safe as longer alternatives.***

The Angle: *Historically, there was very strong guidance that you must always finish an antibiotic course. Now, we're seeing a growing body of evidence saying that that is not always the case. And oftentimes, shorter durations of antibiotics are as effective and safe as longer alternatives.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.sciencealert.com/always-finish-your-antibiotics-is-not-always-best-practice-surprised-youre-not-alone>

■ ***Older adults could face harmful heat stress at just 1.5°C of global warming above preindustrial levels, compared with around 4°C for younger adults, suggesting people aged 60 and over are substantially more vulnerable to extreme heat than previously estimated.***

The Angle: *Older adults could face harmful heat stress at just 1.5°C of global warming above preindustrial levels, compared with around 4°C for younger adults, suggesting people aged 60 and over are substantially more vulnerable to extreme heat than previously estimated.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.theguardian.com/society/2026/aug/17/extreme-heat-more-dangerous-for-people-60-and-over-than-previously-thought>

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ ***After more than 20 years of work, 266 Indigenous clan leaders from 41 villages in Papua New Guinea have signed a legally binding agreement protecting 125,000 hectares of rainforest from logging and mining, creating a huge community led refuge for tree kangaroos and other wildlife.***

The Angle: *After more than 20 years of work, 266 Indigenous clan leaders from 41 villages in Papua New Guinea have signed a legally binding agreement protecting 125,000 hectares of rainforest from logging and mining, creating a huge community led refuge for tree kangaroos and other wildlife.*

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.mongabay.com/2026/08/new-conservation-deed-aims-to-protect-tree-kangaroos-forests-people-in-papua-new-guinea/>

Backup options:

■ ***Armwood High graduate uses 40 scholarships to attend Princeton***

The Angle: *Armwood High graduate uses 40 scholarships to attend Princeton*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Inactive tall children develop disproportionately weak muscles and thinner bones. Regular sports fully reverse this deficit.*

The Angle: *Inactive tall children develop disproportionately weak muscles and thinner bones. Regular sports fully reverse this deficit.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://karger.com/hrp/article/doi/10.1159/000552378/948683/Muscle-Function-and-Bone-Strength-in-Children-and>

■ *Digital amnesia. Taking screenshots makes you more likely to forget information. Many of us take more photos and screenshots than we can use — around 20 photos a day, with around 2,000 photos stored on the average smartphone, according to estimates.*

The Angle: *Digital amnesia. Taking screenshots makes you more likely to forget information. Many of us take more photos and screenshots than we can use — around 20 photos a day, with around 2,000 photos stored on the average smartphone, according to estimates.*

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.binghamton.edu/news/story/6397/digital-amnesia-taking-screenshots-makes-you-more-likely-to-forget-information>

■ *Heated Rivalry author donates \$300K to 5 rural libraries facing closure*

The Angle: *Heated Rivalry author donates \$300K to 5 rural libraries facing closure*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/nova-scotia/heated-rivalry-author-rachel-reid-donates-300k-to-avrl-9.7310023>

■ *Canadian Tire... it's a little too early.*

The Angle: *Canadian Tire... it's a little too early.*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://i.redd.it/zb8of0okw0kh1.jpeg>

■ *Carney says last-minute U.S. tariff negotiations are 'delicate' and 'intense' as deadline looms*

The Angle: *Carney says last-minute U.S. tariff negotiations are 'delicate' and 'intense' as deadline looms*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/carney-negotiations-delicate-intense-9.7309934>

■ *John Oliver Brutally Mocks Trump for Sacrificing Staff in Airplane-Swap Incident*

The Angle: John Oliver Brutally Mocks Trump for Sacrificing Staff in Airplane-Swap Incident

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/john-oliver-mocks-trump-sacrificing-staff-airplane-swap-incident-iran-1236836013/>

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)

- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)

- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground

<https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt> <https://t.co/HwXL2>" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)

- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC <https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o>" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)

- "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)

- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)

- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels"

(www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)

- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)

- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)

- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: "Disappointed""

(www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)

- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)

- "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online"

(www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)

- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)

- "'Roseanne' Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)

- "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)"

(www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)

- "Chip Gaines Makes Rare Appearance with Wife Joanna on Magnolia Journal's Milestone 10th Anniversary Cover - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)

- "'Cause we (still) rock! The Jonas Brothers introduce a new generation in nostalgia-filled Camp Rock 3 (exclusive)" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-14)

- "Ugly inning, quiet bats doom Yankees in disappointing loss to Blue Jays" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-14)

- "JENNIE hears the BLINKs, and now, she's sharing regrets from her heart after fans expressed they were feeling let down by the lack of celebr" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-17)

- "Vin Diesel and Meadow Walker arrive to 'The Fast and the Furious' 25th Anniversary Screening in LA

<https://t.co/zDNowKjfdg>" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-08-17)

- "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt 'Disappointed' by BLACKPINK's 10th Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-18)

Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "JENNIE Offers Heartfelt Apology After Fans Felt 'Disappointed' by BLACKPINK's 10th Anniversary"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/futurology (no posts cleared the 300+ upvotes bar - 4 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 1 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-18 09:06 AM